from 10 to 4 miles, speeding train movement. Meanwhile, 165 miles of double tracking had been installed.

Two ferry terminals were added to the one original. Seven barges were increased to 12, one tug to three. Tugs were kept on the move instead of being allowed to stand by a ferry barge during loading or unloading. When the Army arrived, not more than 200 cars were moved each way a day across the wide river. In January 1945, the average was approximately 800 a day each way.

Train lengths were increased from 40 cars to an average of 80 and in some cases more than 100. Speeds were increased from 25 miles per hour to an average of 45. The number of passenger trains was more than doubled and the trains were running on time. [11 8]

HOW RAILWAY WORKSHOPS MADE GRENADES AND ARMOURED CARS

When World War I began, railway workshops were quickly diverted to meet the needs of war and converted into ammunition plants. The workshop administrative office was used as an armoury and they produced everything from hand grenades to 4.5-inch Howitzers and 25-pounder shell forgings.

This is the story of how the stalwarts of the East Indian Railway's Carriage and Wagon shops at Lillooah (Liluah, in Howrah district) did a great job during the war, excerpted from an article by D.K. Whitworth in the *East Indian Railway Magazine* , 1945. [119]

In the year 1938, long before Dunkirk and Pearl Harbour, the Carriage & Wagon shops at Lillooah had little else of importance to attend to than the maintenance of a steady flow of vehicles for passenger and goods service over the 4,000-mile track of her Railway.

Early each morning, punctual to the hour, workmen's trains would arrive. With the siren at 4.30 in the afternoon, work would cease and the men, perhaps not quite as clean and colourful as before, would troop out and board their respective homebound trains. A perfectly peaceful everyday routine .

As the World War broke, the workshop at Liluah, as elsewhere, turned to manufacturing war-time requirements of grenades, tanks and ambulances.

In 1942, India was first faced with the problem of defending her soil from the invader. In Lillooah, volunteers were called upon to form a Defence Unit, and the alacrity with which men responded to the call may only be described as superb. And so, time went by. Military discipline was slowly but effectively drilled into the men.

In the shops both men and machines worked at feverish speed to keep the wheels turning. More wagons were required for supplies. More carriages were urged for troops. And with the passing of days, an ever-increasing demand for even more and more vehicles had to be coped with. No matter what the requirements, whether for the transport of men and material, guns and supplies, Lillooah was always ready to answer the call.

Ambulances and Tanks